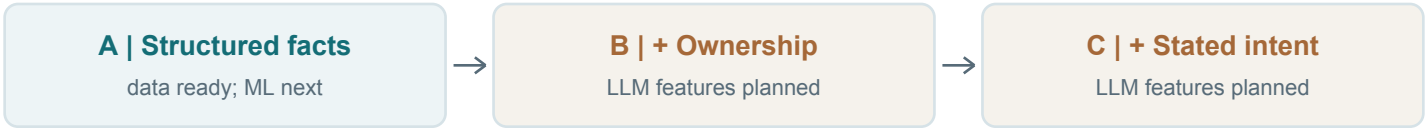
Can 13D disclosures become a useful investment signal?

Private Markets Modeling discussion | 13 October 2026 | Data and research design

Idea: combine public ownership disclosures with dated market data to test whether investor characteristics and stated plans help select stocks after disclosure. The central class deliverable is a neural-network experiment; LLM extraction supplies additional candidate inputs. Alpha is the hypothesis, not a finding.



What is ready today

Evidence	What it means
75,631 filing records 2013-September 2026	Source-audited archive, including initial filings, amendments and unresolved records. A filing count is not a count of independent investments.
15,813 initial candidates 2013-2025	Factual staging completed. Separate from the narrower return-analysis sample; not all have usable stock or benchmark data.
667 joined event candidates Entries 2018-2023	Ten structured inputs; outcomes extend through 2025. Ownership summaries exist for 557, with 110 missing. Chronological preprocessing is complete; no predictive model fitted.

Existing inputs cover dated company size and industry, reporting-person counts, reported-percentage summaries, filing/event lag and prior disclosure activity. Rule-based parsing is repeatable, but it does not resolve every ownership relationship or verify total economic ownership.

HFR is a starting investor screen

The screen uses **35 supplied historical HFR snapshots (2018 Q1-2026 Q3)**, exact normalized firm/fund-name matches and seven fixed supplemental activist groups. It finds 180 historical HFR firm-ID candidates, not 180 validated economic managers. HFR categories describe strategies offered by a firm; they do not establish an individual filing's intent. [1]

Use the latest prior supplied snapshot; delivery-folder dates are an unverified availability proxy. Earlier archive years lack HFR coverage. Unmatched does not mean non-hedge-fund or passive. **HFR groups currently support diagnostics, not model inputs**, pending identity and historical-availability validation.

The experiment I propose

Predict the subsequent 504-trading-session stock return minus its assigned Russell benchmark. Compare a small neural network with regularized regression and boosted trees. Start with rule-based facts, then add validated ownership/identity interpretation, then stated intent, using comparable samples and chronological evaluation. Selection, timing, horizon and sizing are later investment-policy decisions.

The 2023 input preparation has only 365 earlier events with matured outcomes, so model capacity must be constrained. Current historical results are development evidence, not an untouched test. Benchmark-relative return is the initial target; risk adjustment and trading costs still matter before claiming alpha. Simple following has not established a reliable edge.

From filing records to model observations

Current unit: an eligible initial-disclosure event linked to a historical stock, entry date and subsequent return window. The sample below inherits portfolio-following rules; whether each rule belongs in the ML panel is a discussion point.

Separate return-sample path	Why the count changes
17,795 metadata initial records	Older metadata registry; not the source-audited initial count or the 15,813 factual-staging cohort.
4,673 screened records	2018-2025 entry window, review exclusions, standalone/source, security and basic trading checks.
4,440 first-pair records	Remove 233 prior investor-issuer history records; first observed in this archive is not necessarily first ever.
2,107 two-year scheduled events	Remove 1,995 for overlap / multiple securities / insufficient calendar; same-entry, same-issuer merges reduce records by 338.
694 calculable benchmark labels	712 assigned benchmarks, less 18 return refusals. Another 1,395 scheduled events lack the required historical benchmark match.
667 single-filing feature rows	Defer 27 merged events until their aggregation rule is defined. All 667 join to prepared facts.

The 75,631-record archive, 15,813-candidate staging cohort and this return-sample path serve different purposes; they are not one sequential funnel.

Keep the broader covered universe

Focused activist*	Other Event-Driven	Other HFR	Other / unresolved
55	12	44	556

*Disjoint groups sum to 667; the focused group includes the fixed supplements. These are candidate labels. The 556 other/unresolved events remain in scope; missing identity is not a reason to call them passive or exclude them.

All archived filings can support factual preparation and disclosure histories. Supervised learning needs usable stock links and observed outcomes; missing returns cannot become zero-return labels. Amendments can become context or separately timed update observations. Future amendments must never enter an earlier row. **Proposed review:** retain overlaps in a broader ML panel with issuer/time safeguards, rather than automatically inheriting the portfolio non-overlap filter.

What industry already does - and what remains open

13D Monitor sells qualitative activism research and describes screening 13D filings. [2] BlackRock Systematic describes LLM analysis of financial text for investment forecasting. [3] Aladdin describes NLP extraction from private-market reports in eFront Insight. [4] These are related precedents; they do not verify this exact 13D-to-ML pipeline or establish its incremental alpha.

Input sought: an appropriate investor definition, defensible observation rules, and a tractable information question that would make this a useful investment-data project.

Public sources, checked 12 October 2026: [1] HFR strategy definitions; [2] 13D Monitor: About Us; [3] BlackRock: How AI is Transforming Investing; [4] Aladdin: Turning Tables on Automation.

Local evidence and exact source hashes: companion speaking-notes page. Data preparation and proposed research design; no trained predictive model or measured LLM contribution. AI-assisted preparation.